Search: is it worth asking about?

Team _____

Date _____

How: 30 to 60 minutes at a laptop. Spend about 10 minutes on each of boxes 2 to 5. Search for the problem, not for your idea. Write down what you find, then decide on side 2.

REMEMBER: Searching online does NOT prove the problem is real. It only tells you if the problem is worth asking people about. Only real conversations can show the problem is real.

1 MY PROBLEM GUESS

Started from a product idea? What problem does it fix, and for who? Write that problem here, not your product.

Who has it? _____

What goes wrong for them? _____

_____

Words I will search for _____

Type it the way an annoyed person would: **"why is ___ so hard"**, **"how do I stop ___"**. Try Finnish words too.

2 COMPLAINTS

People saying the problem hurts, in their own words.

Look in: Reddit, forums, Facebook groups, Discord, YouTube comments.

What I found (their words, or a link)

_____

_____

_____

_____

How many different people? _____

3 BAD REVIEWS

1 and 2 star reviews of products that try to fix it. What do people hate?

Look in: app stores, Google reviews, Amazon, Trustpilot.

What I found (their words, or a link)

_____

_____

_____

_____

How many different people? _____

4 WORKAROUNDS

Things people make or do **themselves** to cope with the problem.

Look in: templates, DIY guides, spreadsheets, "how I deal with..." posts.

What I found (what they do, or a link)

_____

_____

_____

_____

How many workarounds? _____

5 EXISTING ALTERNATIVES

Companies or tools that already solve it. People paying for one is a **good** sign.

Look in: Google, app stores, "best tools for..." lists.

Who solves it	What it costs
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____

How many cost money? _____

AI USE AI LIKE THIS

Good prompts

1 "Where do people with [problem] talk about it online? Give me links to forums, groups and threads."

2 "Which products already try to fix [problem]? What do their users complain about? Give me links."

3 "Argue against me. Why might [problem] not be a big deal for [who]?"

Bad prompt

~~"Is this a good idea?"~~

AI tends to say yes. It has never met your customers.

Decide: is it worth asking about?

Team _____

Date _____

How: Fill this in right after side 1. Use only what you wrote down there, not what you hope is true.

6 COUNT WHAT YOU FOUND

WHAT	How many	Good sign if
Real complaints (box 2 + box 3)		5 or more, from different people
Workarounds (box 4)		1 or more
Paid alternatives (box 5)		1 or more

Count rules: Count only what you can show a link to. The same person twice counts once. Something AI told you counts only after you opened it and read it yourself.

7 WHAT SURPRISED YOU?

Did people complain about something close to your guess, but not the same? Did a group you didn't expect show up?

_____

_____

_____

_____

8 DECIDE: PICK ONE

☐ **Go to Customer Segments**

Pick this if: you found 5 or more complaints from different people, and at least 1 workaround or paid alternative.

Next: fill in the hand-off box below.

☐ **Change my problem guess**

Pick this if: people complain, but about something next to your guess. Or a different group has it worse.

Next: rewrite box 1 and search again. One more round only.

☐ **Drop it, for now**

Pick this if: you tried new search words and found almost nothing.

Next: go back to your list of ideas.

Found nothing online? That does not prove there is no problem. Some people, like nurses, farmers or small companies, rarely post about work online. Ask before you drop it.

We chose this because _____

_____

_____

TAKE THIS TO CUSTOMER SEGMENTS

My problem guess now _____

Groups who complained the most _____

_____

Next: Take this to the **Customer Segments Worksheet**.

BEFORE YOU MOVE ON, CHECK

- ☐ Did we search the problem, not our idea?
- ☐ Did we check every AI answer ourselves?
- ☐ Can we show a link for everything we counted?
- ☐ Did we write down what we found, not what we hoped?